



# Social Media Report



IVANA MERCKEL &  
KIM WINDVOGEL

6 MONTH REPORT

# Summery

This report presents a 6 month review of groundWork's Facebook and Instagram performance from November 2025 to May 2026, tracking growth, reach and engagement across the organisation's digital campaigns.

# Context

As groundWork's Digital Media Consultants, we were contracted in November 2025 to design and manage a consistent, high-quality social media presence across Facebook and Instagram in support of the Clean Air Fund community awareness campaigns and the groundWork brand .

# Goal

## **Consistency**

Deliver 12 high-quality posts per month across priority campaigns

## **Awareness**

Grow reach and visibility for groundWork Social Media

## **Engagement**

Build an active, engaged audience around environmental justice issues

## **Reporting**

Track and report performance to inform content strategy

NOVEMBER

Facebook followers



3.7K

Instagram followers



1.4K

NOW

Facebook followers



4.2K

Instagram followers



2.9K

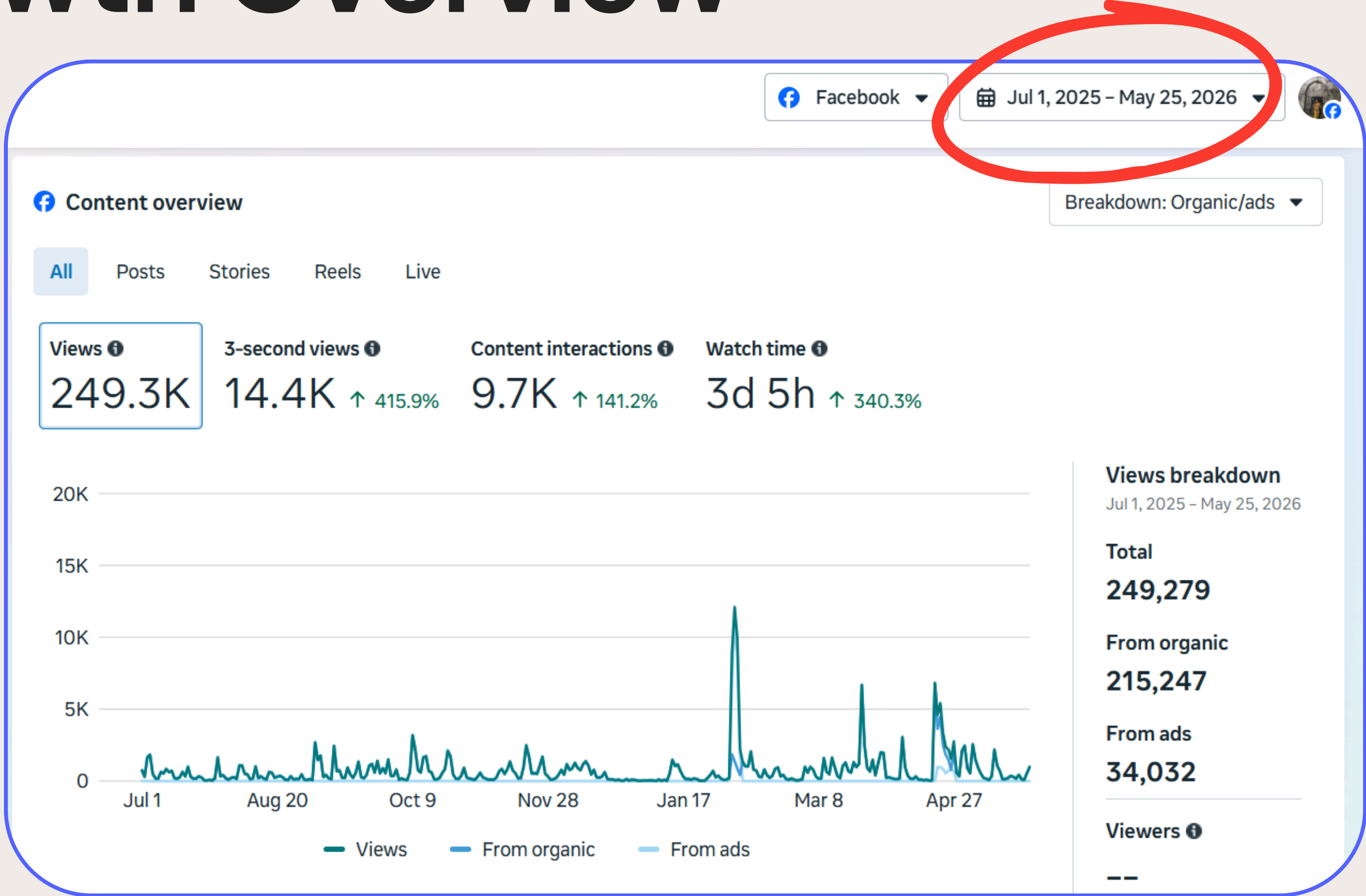


# Comparative Insights

Our social media presence showed strong growth this period, with higher reach, engagement, and follower gains driven by consistent content performance.

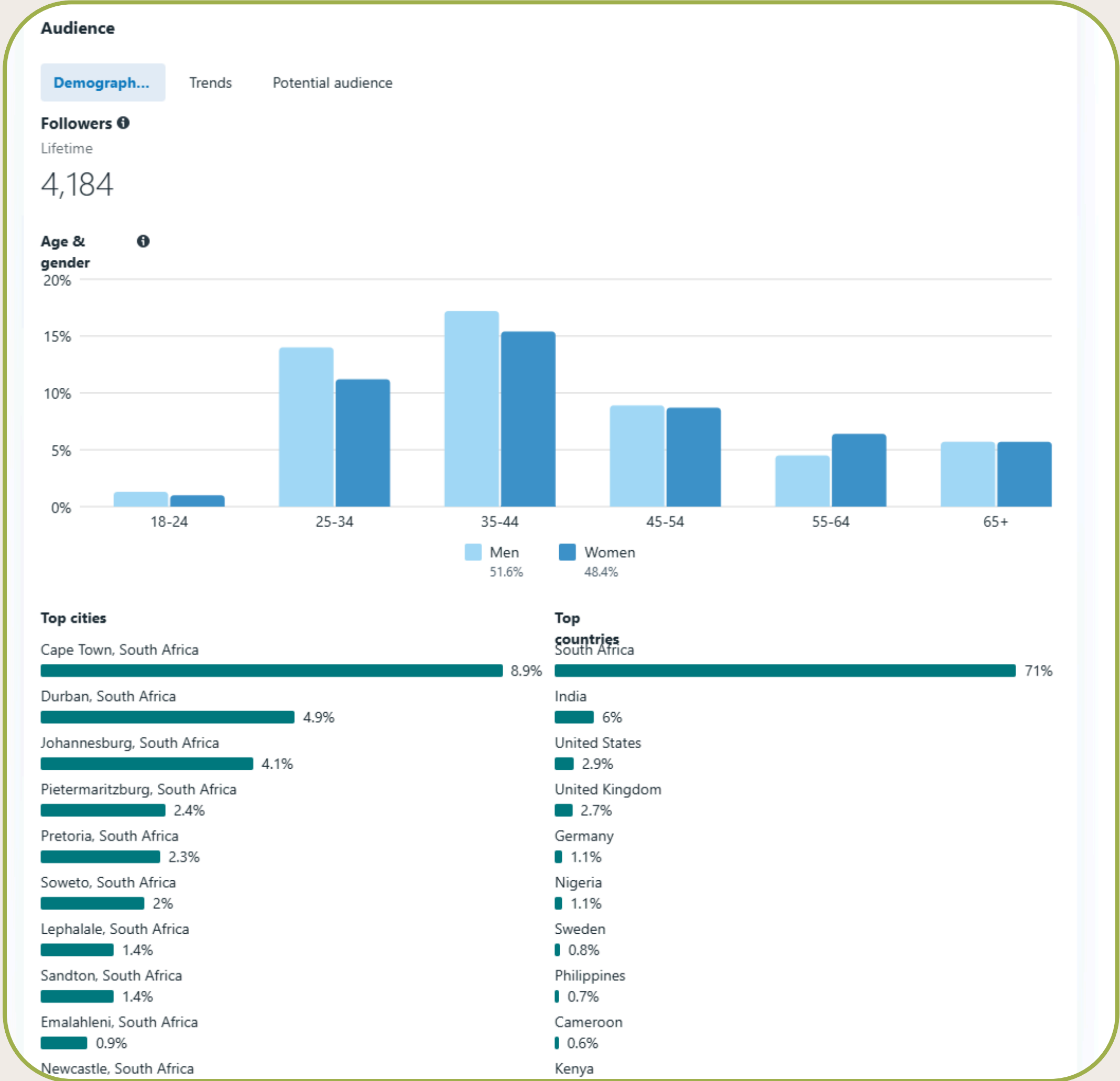
| Metrics              | Nov 2024 /<br>May 2025 | Nov 2025/<br>May 2026 |
|----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Total Views          | 168.8 K                | 178.7 K               |
| Content Interactions | 3 k                    | 6.6K                  |
| New Followers        | 156                    | 411                   |
| Visits               | 3.6 K                  | 65K                   |
| Content Output       | 79 Posts               | 177 Posts             |

# Growth Overview



# Audience Insights

Our social media demographics support who we are creating for and how we can adjust our content to reach larger audiences. This insight gives us a breakdown of which cities are consuming our content and which areas we should be targeting.

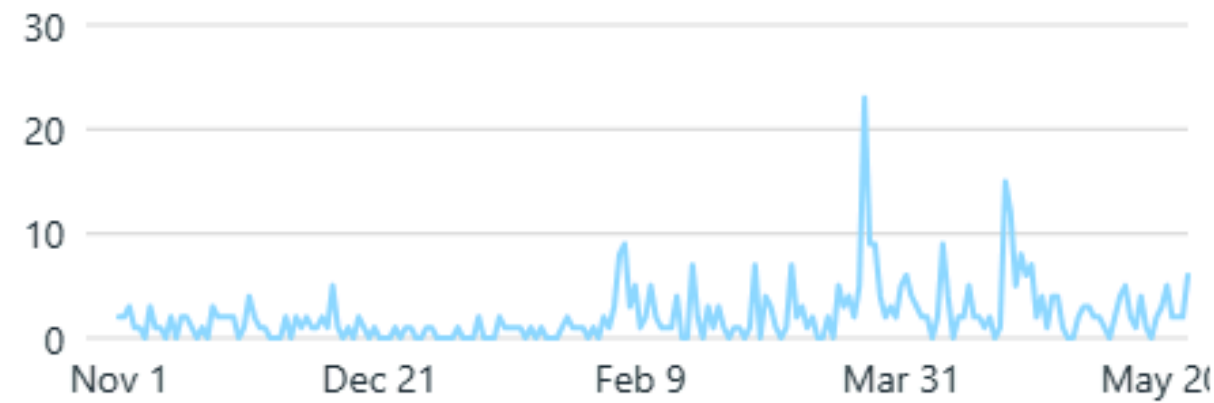


# The Data

Facebook data analytics

## Follows ⓘ

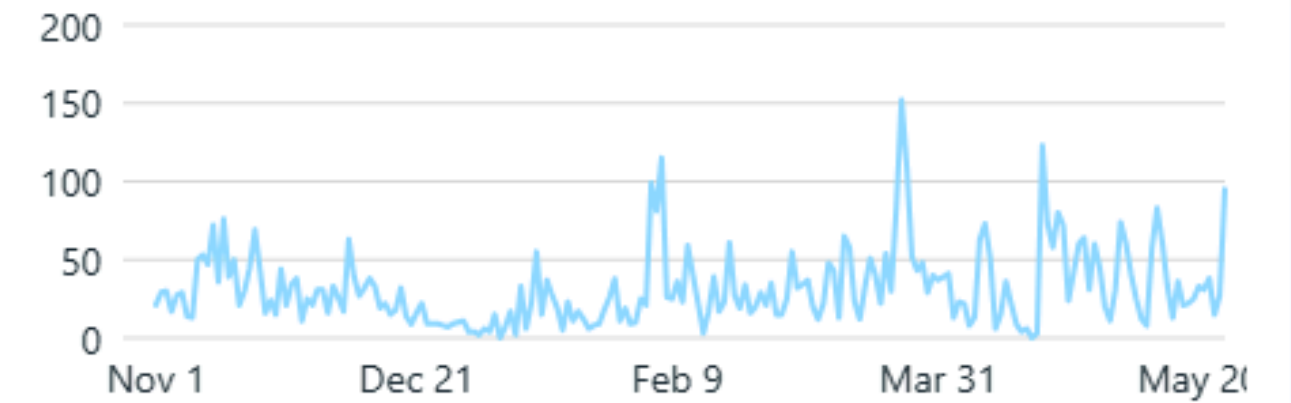
411 ↑ 63.7%



Facebook follows

## Visits ⓘ

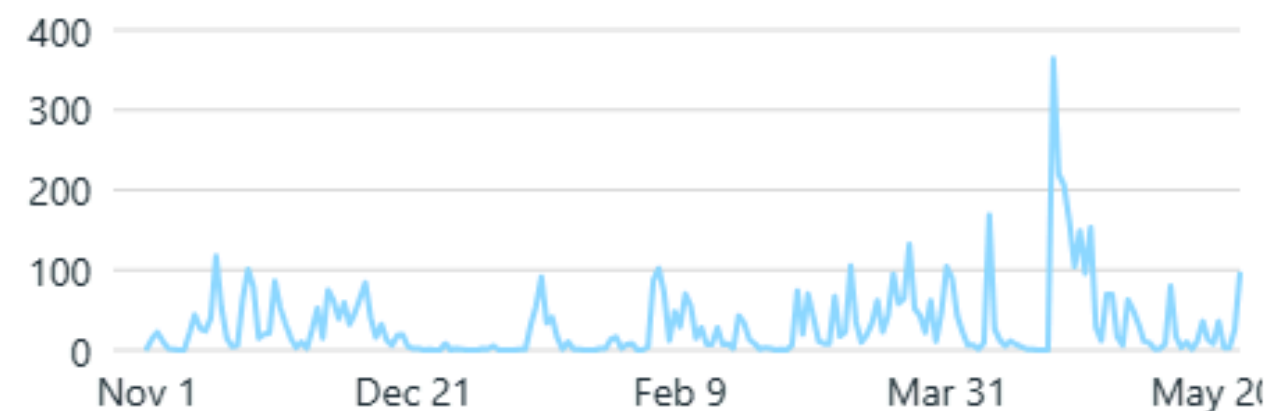
6.5K ↑ 4.9%



Facebook visits

## Content interactions ⓘ

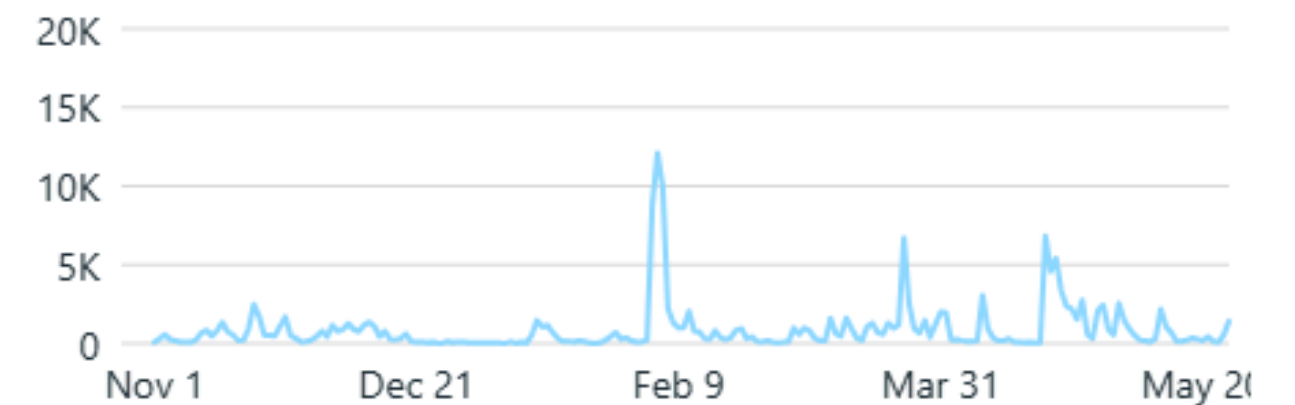
6.6K ↑ 35.2%



Content interactions

## Views ⓘ

178.7K ↑ 1.5%

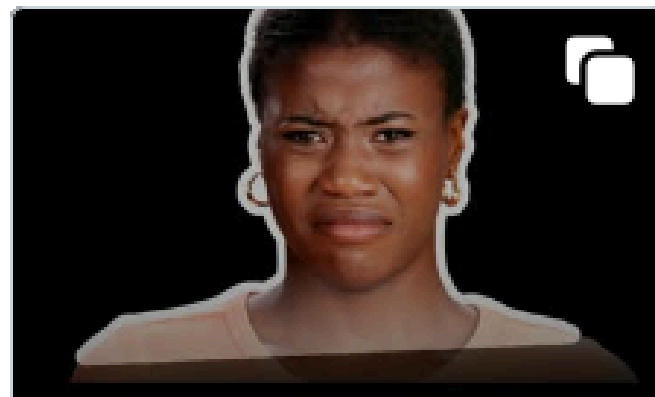


Views



# Top Performing Content

## Top content by views

[Boost content](#)[See all content](#)

Did your house smell of rotten eggs in **JOZI**?

What's that smell that's been hovering...

🕒 Wed Feb 4, 2:37pm

👁 32.2K    ❤ 134  
💬 14    ➡ 31

South Durban Just Transition Project  
THE FUTURE OF SOUTH DURBAN IS CHANGING  
Will it work for our communities - or against us?

- 01 WHO THIS IS ABOUT  
This is ABOUT YOU! Residents of Newmarket, Newmarket, Umhlanga, Umhlanga and the greater South Durban Basin. Workers, Youth, Local businesses, Community leaders. Your voice matters | Your future matters.
- 02 THE REALITY  
For years, our communities have lived with pollution, health challenges and uncertain economic futures. Now, as industries across the globe & locally move to cleaner energy the big question is: What happens next?
- 03 WHAT IS THE SOUTH DURBAN JUST TRANSITION PROJECT?  
Led by Groundwork, the project aims to work with the South Durban communities to ensure the shift to a cleaner economy is NOT only about the environment, it's about protecting livelihoods, improving air quality & health, and creating opportunities for residents, local businesses and youth in 1400 communities. Put communities at the centre of decisions.
- 04 WHY IT MATTERS  
The transition to cleaner energy will impact our health, our livelihoods, our businesses, our children's future. We must make sure: People come before profit | Polluters clean up and pay up.
- 05 NOTHING ABOUT US, WITHOUT US  
Be part of the conversation. In the coming months groundworkers will host dialogues, town hall meetings and other community engagements. Follow our WhatsApp Channel for more updates & look out for our teams in your area in the coming months. Let us be empowered, stay engaged and move toward a JUST transition for South Durban.

Our South Durban Just Transition campaign...

🕒 Mon Apr 20, 3:10pm

👁 13.0K    ❤ 610  
💬 13    ➡ 29

**HIRING**  
**ENVIRONMENTAL JUSTICE EDUCATION INTERNSHIP**

We're looking for someone who:

- ✓ Is 18 years to 35 years of age
- ✓ Holds a qualification in Social Sciences, Development or Environmental Studies (or equivalent experience)
- ✓ Resides in Durban
- ✓ Is passionate about environmental justice and community development (or willing to learn)
- ✓ Is fluent in at least two South African languages - (additional languages being a bonus).

**APPLY NOW**

Submit your CV to:  
Nozipho Ngonyama (HR Officer)  
nozipho@groundwork.org.za  
for more info go to our website

We are recruiting for an exciting career...

🕒 Tue Mar 24, 1:03pm

👁 9.2K    ❤ 56  
💬 5    ➡ 36

**THE GOLDMAN ENVIRONMENTAL PRIZE**

The Award that should be **Bigger than the Oscars** and the South Africans who won!

Meet the 7 South African heroes who...

🕒 Mon Apr 20, 9:01am

👁 8.2K    ❤ 149  
💬 13    ➡ 43

**Clear Skies Eco-Schools Project**

The Clear Skies Eco-Schools Project aims ...

🕒 Tue May 12, 10:21am

👁 3.0K    ❤ 54  
💬 7    ➡ 7



TI  
JI

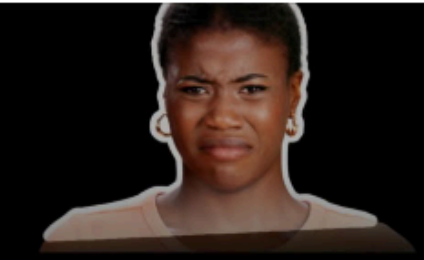
Fr

👁  
💬

# Our Top Performing Content

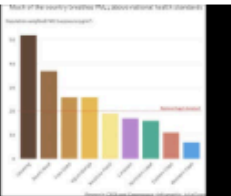
**groundWork**  
Published by [Dorothy Brislin](#) · February 4 ·

What's that smell that's been hovering over Jozi lately? ... [See more](#)

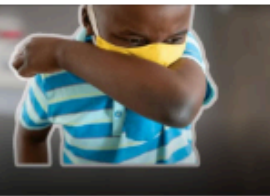


**Did your house smell of rotten eggs in JOZI?**

It was **hydrogen sulphide** drifting in from Mpumalanga industries. Yes! Air pollution travels.



Hydrogen sulphide is a toxic gas from coal & petrochemicals. **The problem:** Only 12 of the 31 air-quality



The smell is more than a warning. In 2023, Air pollution killed **42,000** South Africans, including **1300** children over the age of 5



That stench isn't random! it's fossil fuels & **weak enforcement**

[Boost](#)

  134

 14

 31

 Like  Comment  Share

**groundWork**  
Published by [Dorothy Brislin](#) · April 20 ·

Meet the 7 South African heroes who turned local action into a global legacy. ... [See more](#)



**The Award that should be Bigger than the Oscars and the South Africans who won!**



**Bobby Peek**  
Goldman Environmental Prize Winner

Bobby Peek skillfully united his racially divided community and succeeded in closing illegal toxic dumps in South Durban, a highly industrialised, contaminated community.



**Jonathan Deal**  
Goldman Environmental Prize Winner

With no prior experience in grassroots organising, Jonathan Deal led a successful campaign against fracking in South Africa to protect the Karoo, a semi-desert region treasured for its agriculture.



**Desmond D'Sa**  
Goldman Environmental Prize Winner

Desmond rallied South Durban's diverse and disenfranchised communities and successfully shut down a toxic waste dump that was exposing nearby residents to dangerous chemicals and a blizzard of polycarbonate dust.



**Makoma Limalakala & Lutho Daid**  
Goldman Environmental Prize Winner

Makoma and Lutho, grassroots activists, formed a coalition to halt South Africa's secret \$16 billion nuclear deal with Russia. On April 26, 2023, the High Court deemed the project unconstitutional, marking a significant legal victory that safeguarded South

[Boost](#)

  149

 13

 43

 Love  Comment  Share

**groundWork**  
Published by [Dorothy Brislin](#) · May 12 at 10:21 AM ·

The Clear Skies Eco-Schools Project aims to enhance air quality awareness, int... [See more](#)



**Clear Skies Eco-Schools Project**

**THE PROBLEM**

South Africa faces significant challenges related to air pollution, with several regions officially designated as **high-risk 'Priority Areas'** under the Air Quality Act.

**GROUNDWORK IN PARTNERSHIP WITH WESSA BRINGS YOU THE CLEAR SKIES ECO-SCHOOLS PROJECT**

The project pursues four interrelated objectives designed to promote clean air through **education, capacity building, and community mobilisation.**

**1. ENHANCE AIR QUALITY AWARENESS**

Improve understanding of **open waste burning**, air pollution sources, health impacts, mitigation actions among learners, teachers, and community members.

**2. INTEGRATE CLEAN AIR INTO ENVIRONMENTAL EDUCATION**

Embed air quality and environmental themes into school curricula and Eco-Schools activities.

[Boost](#)

  You and 53 others

 7

 7

 Like  Comment  Share

| Overview |         |              |             |
|----------|---------|--------------|-------------|
| Views    | Viewers | Interactions | Link clicks |
| 32.2K    | 26.4K   | 186          | 8           |

| Overview |         |              |             |
|----------|---------|--------------|-------------|
| Views    | Viewers | Interactions | Link clicks |
| 8.2K     | 5.0K    | 204          | --          |

| Overview |         |              |             |
|----------|---------|--------------|-------------|
| Views    | Viewers | Interactions | Link clicks |
| 3.0K     | 1.5K    | 68           | --          |

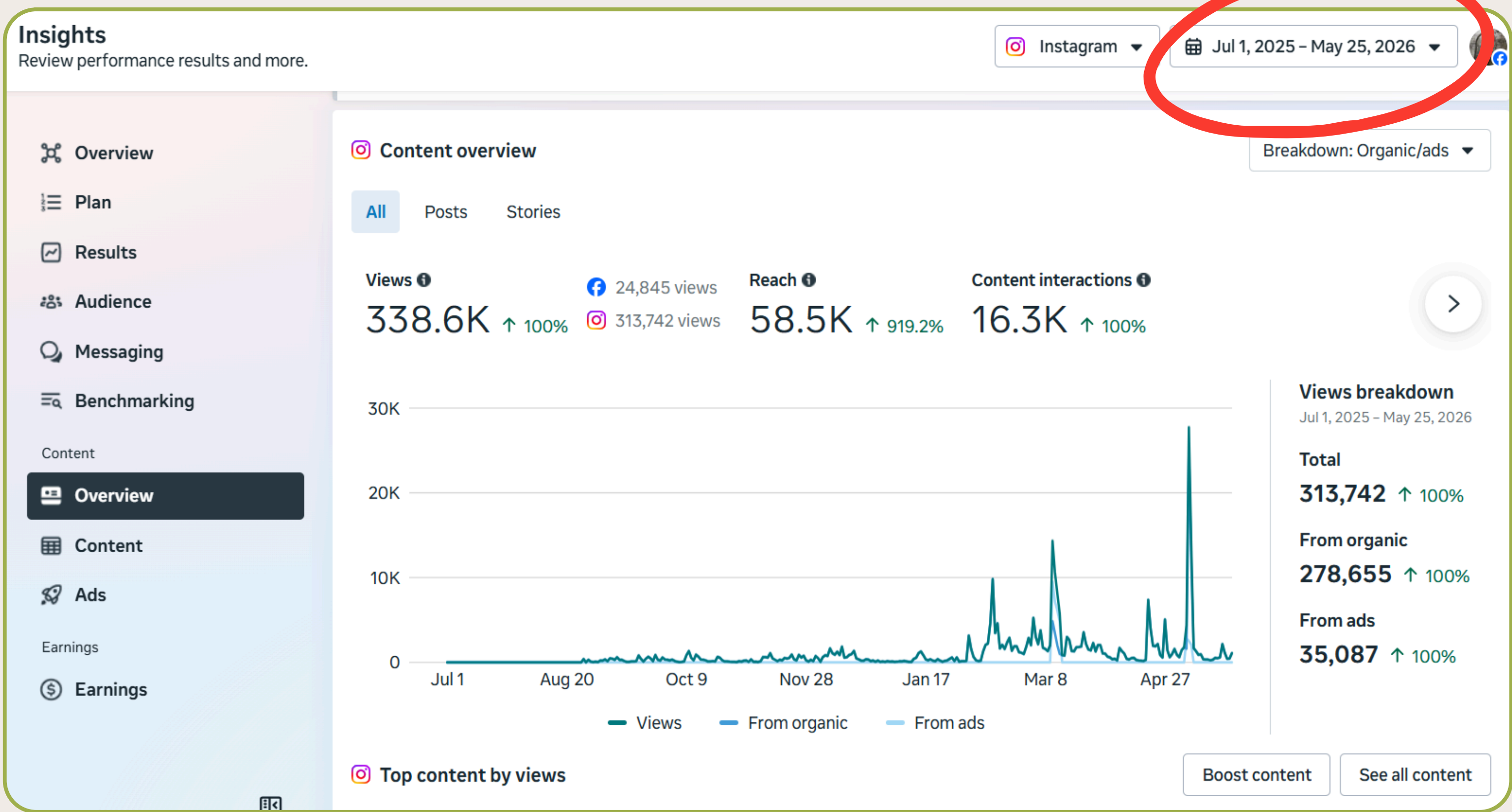


# Comparative Insights

Our social media presence showed strong growth this period, with higher reach, engagement, and follower gains driven by consistent content performance. gW’s Instagram account was started in April 2023

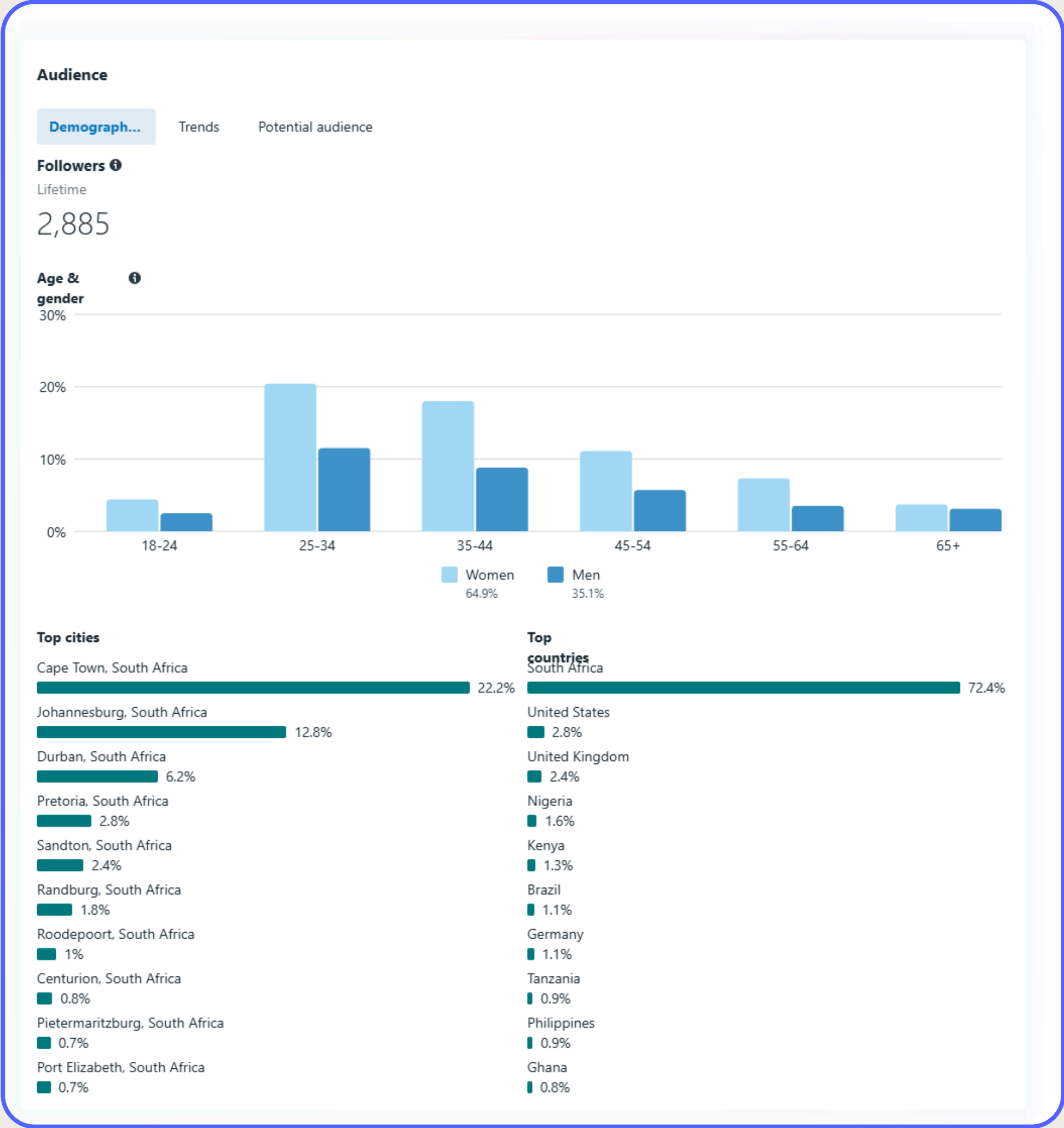
| Metrics              | Nov 2024 /<br>May 2025 | Nov 2025/<br>May 2026 |
|----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Total Views          | 3.9K (reach)           | 319.2K                |
| Content Interactions | N/A                    | 15.4K                 |
| New Followers        | 18                     | 1.5K                  |
| Visits               | 807                    | 3.3K                  |
| Content Output       | 91 Posts               | 284 Posts             |

# Growth Overview



# Audience Insights

Our social media demographics support who we are creating for and how we can adjust our content to reach larger audiences. This insight gives us a breakdown of which cities are consuming our content and which areas we should be targeting.

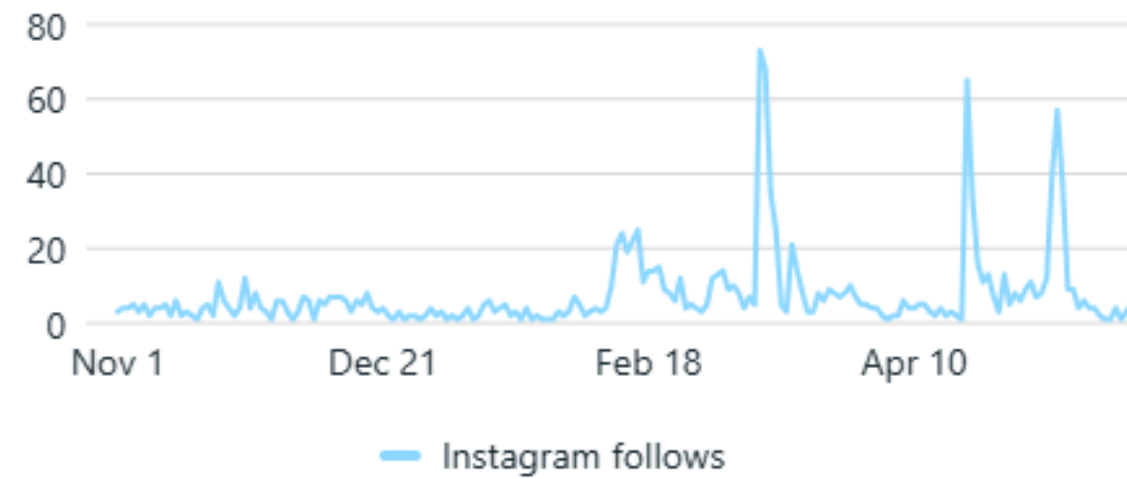


# The Data

Instagram  
data analytics

## Follows ⓘ

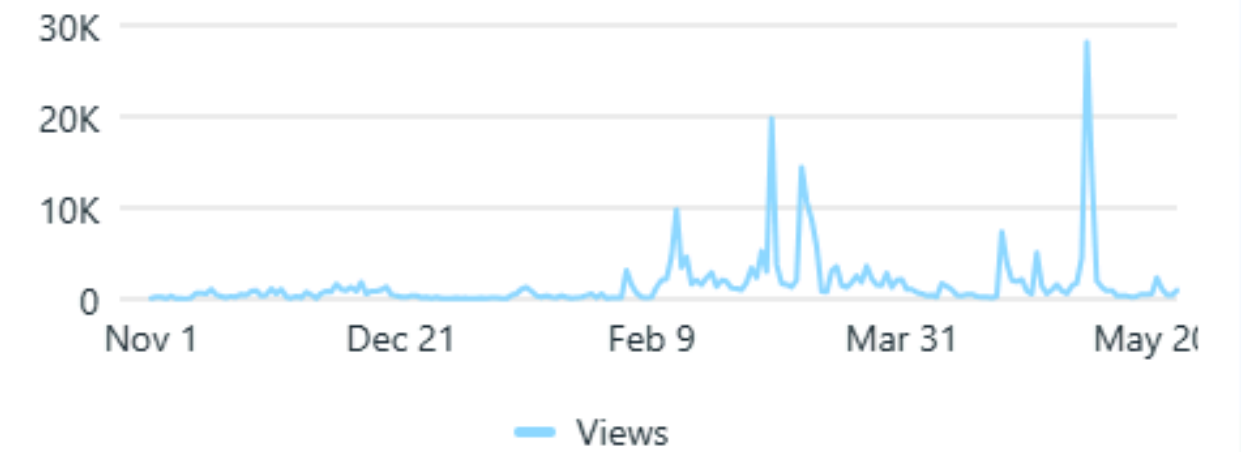
1.5K ↑ 205.7%



## Views ⓘ

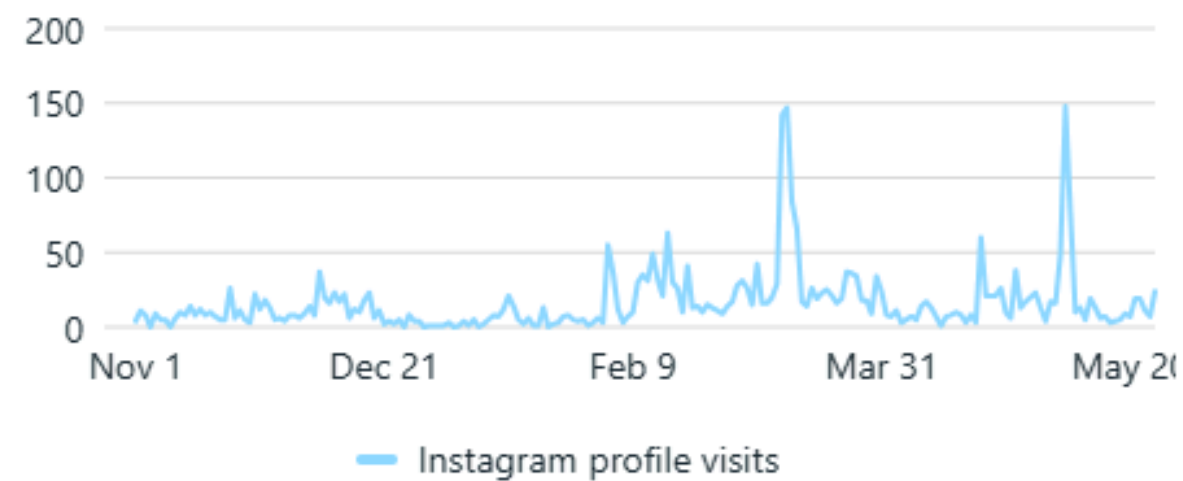
319.2K ↑ 1.6K%

Facebook 24,843 views  
Instagram 294,333 views



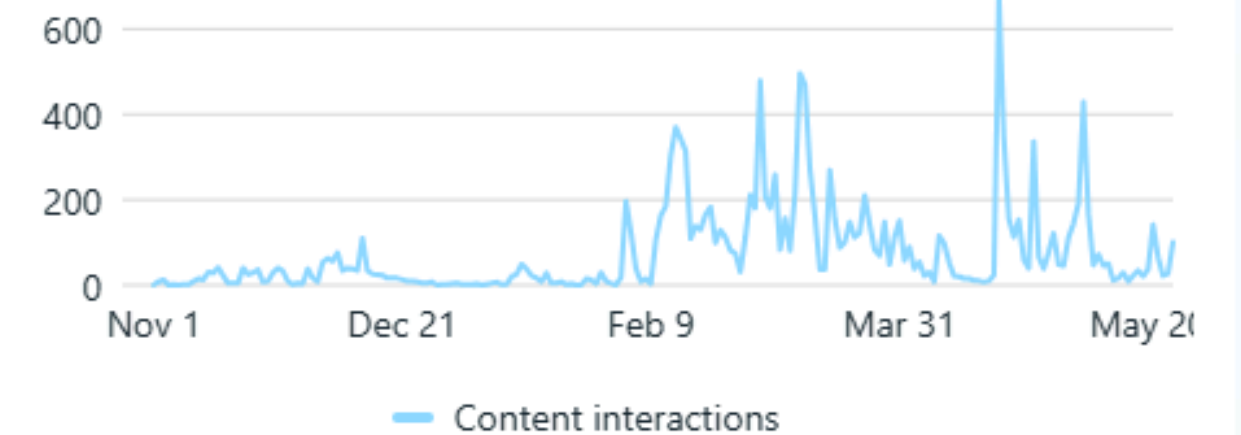
## Visits ⓘ

3.3K ↑ 157.7%



## Content interactions ⓘ

15.4K ↑ 1.6K%





# Top Performing Content

## Top content by views

Boost content

See all content



**What do Mpumalanga, South Africa and The Hunger Games have in common?**

🧐 Check out our Environmental Healt...

Tue Feb 10, 8:01pm

👁 39.9K    ❤ 1.8K  
💬 12    ➡ 214



**Dr Tamlynn Fleetwood**

1982 - 2026

**In memory of Dr Tamlynn Fleetwood...**

Thu May 7, 1:49pm

👁 37.0K    ❤ 292  
💬 12    ➡ 9



**ONE OF THE WORLD'S MOST POLLUTED PLACES IS IN SOUTH AFRICA**

**The Vaal Triangle:**  
Residents face a dilemma between the need for

**In the Vaal Triangle, the air smells of rotten...**

📍 Wed Mar 11, 8:04am

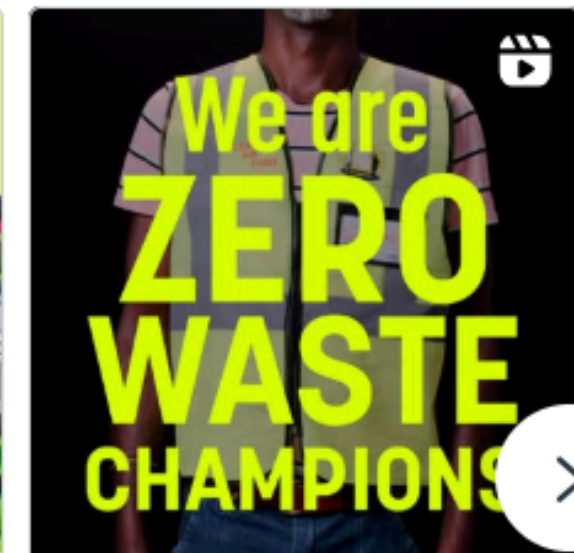
👁 30.8K    ❤ 696  
💬 29    ➡ 114



**Today is International Waste Picker Day....**

📍 Sun Mar 1, 1:12pm

👁 29.9K    ❤ 1.1K  
💬 15    ➡ 62

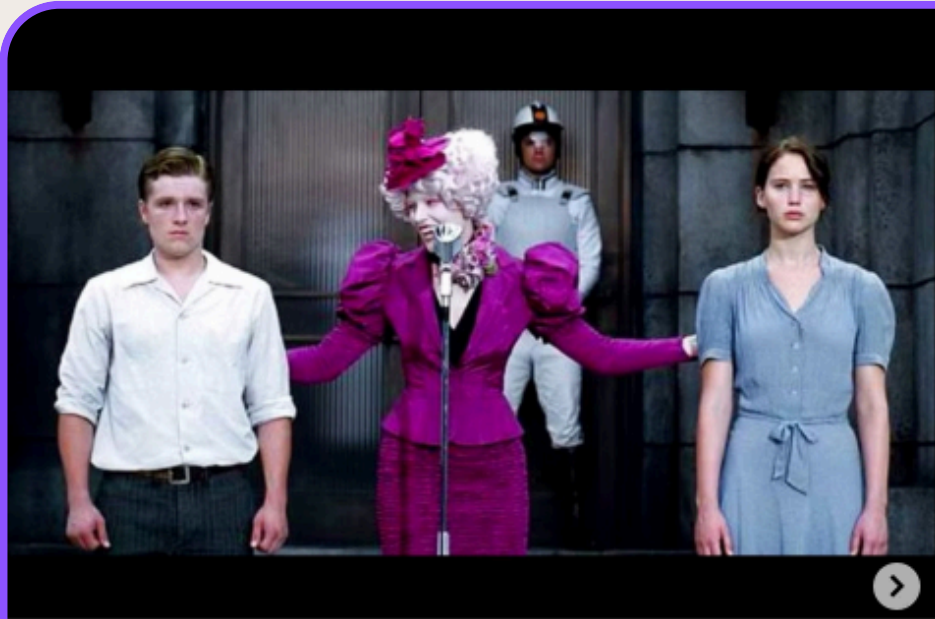


**Waste pickers are more than just recyclers....**

📍 Tue Mar 3, 8:26am

👁 19.0K    ❤ 1.6K  
💬 39    ➡ 142

# Our Top Performing Content



**What do Mpumalanga, South Africa and The Hunger Games have in common?**

groundwork.sa and lifeaftercoalza  
Phola, Ogies, Mpumalanga

groundwork.sa 15 w

Check out our Environmental Health Campaign Resource Hub (link in bio) on the groundWork Website.

There you'll find THREE Phola Reports, community driven research on the health impacts of living in the Coal 'district' of South Africa.

SWIPE to be informed.

FOLLOW for more environmental justice info and keep in the loop about what's happening around you.

View Insights Boost Post

1.8K 12 289

Liked by sdcea\_ngo and 1,837 others

10 February

| Overview |         |                |           |
|----------|---------|----------------|-----------|
| Views ⓘ  | Reach ⓘ | Interactions ⓘ | Follows ⓘ |
| 39.9K    | 23.0K   | 2.7K           | 96        |



**ONE OF THE WORLD'S MOST POLLUTED PLACES IS IN SOUTH AFRICA**

**The Vaal Triangle:**  
Residents face a dilemma between the need for jobs and the strain of living in extreme pollution.

groundwork.sa  
Sasolburg

groundwork.sa 11 w

In the Vaal Triangle, the air smells of rotten eggs and window ledges are covered in soot - black coal dust.

This is the reality of the world's dependency on steel, oil, and coal.

Do you live in the Vaal Triangle? Tell us about your experience in the 🏠 COMMENTS below!

SWIPE to be informed.

FOLLOW for more #environmentaljustice posts.

View Insights Boost Post

696 29 41

Liked by 3dspiral and 695 others

11 March

Add a comment...

| Overview |         |                |           |
|----------|---------|----------------|-----------|
| Views ⓘ  | Reach ⓘ | Interactions ⓘ | Follows ⓘ |
| 30.8K    | 14.8K   | 1.1K           | 169       |



# Our Top Performing Content



**groundwork.sa**

groundwork.sa Edited • 5 w  
Meet the 7 South African heroes who turned local action into a global legacy. The Goldman Environmental Prize honors grassroots leaders who take significant action for our planet, often without the attention they deserve. We're profiling the incredible impact they've made right here at home. ZA 🌟

#goldmanawards  
#SouthAfrica

lucindajanecoelho 5 w  
Top selection! We are so grateful to these people 🍷

View Insights Boost Post

1.2K 23 70

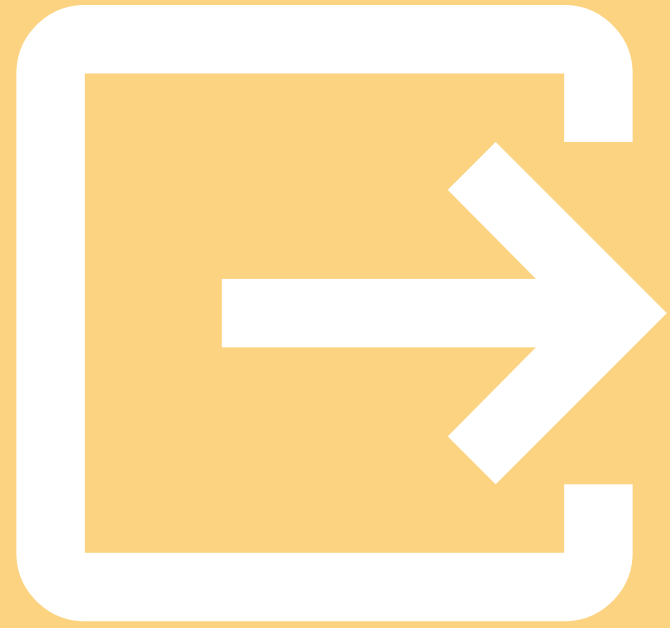
Liked by sdcea\_ngo and 1,160 others  
20 April

Add a comment...

| Overview |         |                |           |
|----------|---------|----------------|-----------|
| Views ⓘ  | Reach ⓘ | Interactions ⓘ | Follows ⓘ |
| 16.6K    | 9.1K    | 1.5K           | 161       |

# Metrics Recap

| Metric                 | Number | Growth   |
|------------------------|--------|----------|
| Instagram Follows      | 1,500  | ↑ 205.7% |
| Instagram Interactions | 15.4K  | ↑ 1,600% |
| Instagram Reach        | 57.6K  | ↑ 1,200% |
| Facebook Follows       | 411    | ↑ 63.7%  |
| Facebook Interactions  | 6.6K   | ↑ 35.2%  |
| Facebook Views         | 178.7K | ↑ 1.5%   |



# Content Output by Month

1 Nov 2025 – 25 May 2026

| MONTH    | FACEBOOK | INSAGRAM |
|----------|----------|----------|
| November | 54       | 34       |
| December | 19       | 73       |
| January  | 12       | 27       |
| February | 14       | 19       |
| March    | 26       | 66       |
| April    | 27       | 37       |
| May      | 25       | 28       |
| TOTAL    | 177      | 284      |

# The Journey of one post

Social media may appear effortless from the outside, but each post represents a coordinated team effort across campaign leads, communications staff and the digital media team, ensuring every piece of content is accurate, on brand and aligned with groundWork's mission and funder requirements

COMMUNICATIONS IS A  
COLLABORATIVE PROSSCESS

1

**Brief & Direction** Communications Director (Dorothy) provides the campaign focus, key message and any funder requirements — intersecting with Mafoko and Musa where relevant

2

## **Research & Copywriting**

Digital consultant researches the topic, drafts the caption, selects hashtags and identifies tagging partners (e.g. Earthlife Africa, Life After Coal, Centre for Environmental Rights, etc)

3

## **Design & Visual Creation**

Graphic design or visual assets are created or sourced, formatted to platform specifications for both Facebook and Instagram

4

**Internal Review Draft** submitted to comms director and or campaign lead for content accuracy and alignment with groundWork's organisational voice and values

5

## **Amendments Feedback incorporated**

sometimes multiple rounds, depending on campaign sensitivity or funder visibility

6

**Approval** Final sign-off from campaign lead or Communications director before scheduling

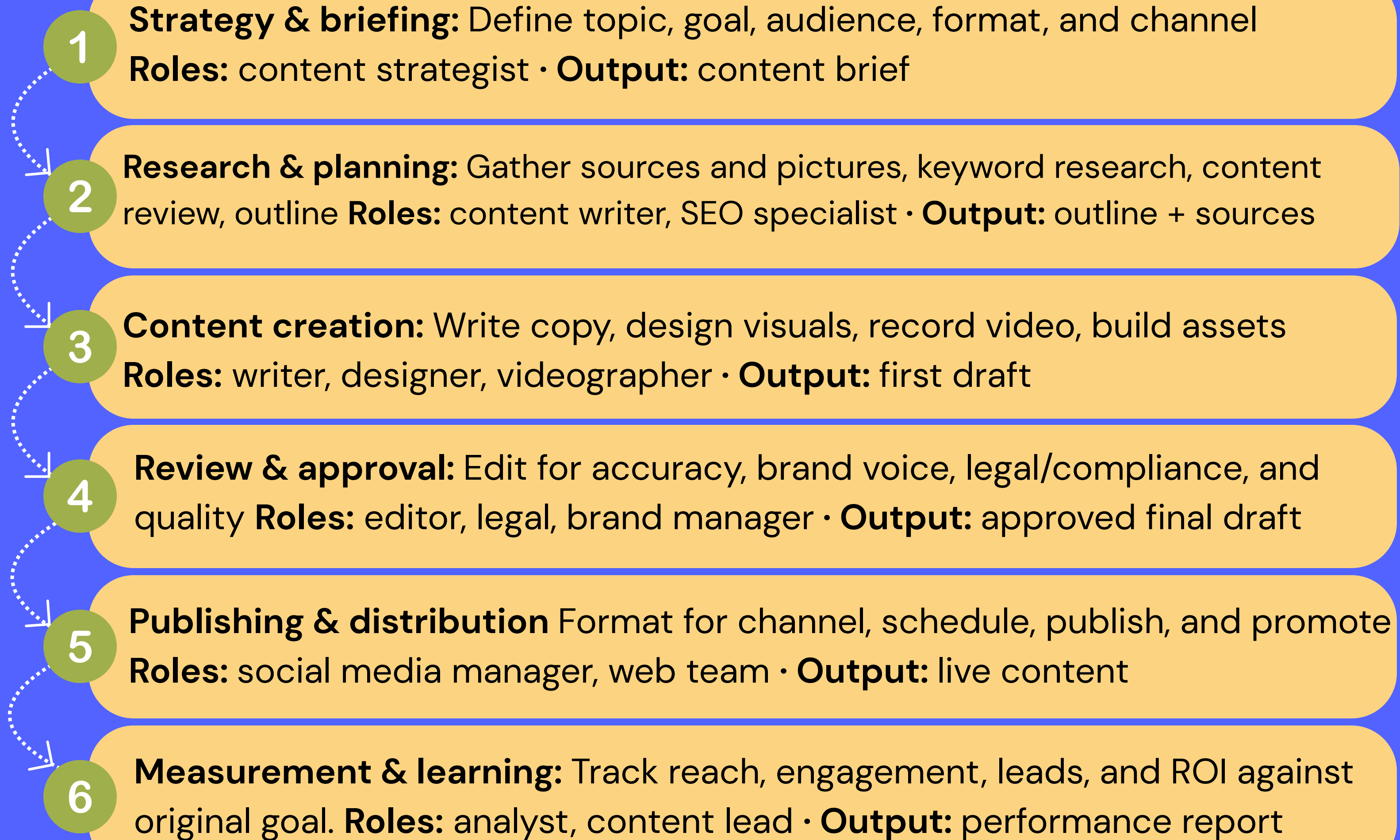
7

**Scheduling & Publishing Post** (Comms director) scheduled or published directly, with platform-specific formatting adjustments. Including captions, hashtags, partners and music

8

**Monitoring Post** monitored for comments, shares and engagement in the days following publication

# Content pipeline



# Content pipeline

1

**Strategy & briefing:** Define topic, goal, audience, format, and channel  
**Roles:** content strategist • **Output:** content brief

## Weekly Meetings

The brief is the most educational artefact in the whole process because it forces every stakeholder to answer: What are we making? For who? Why? A good brief includes the target audience, the goal (awareness vs. conversion vs. retention), the channel and format, the key message, the SEO keyword (if applicable), the deadline, and who approves it.

When staff create a brief, they immediately understand how much thinking happens before a word is written.

# Content pipeline

STAGE 1

## GROUNDWORK WEBSITE

Latest news, Passed projects, Campaigns

## PARTNER WEBSITES

Allied orgs, Funders and coalitions

## PUBLIC INFORMATION

Articles, relevant searches and credible sources

STAGE 2

## THE JUST TRANSITION OPEN AGENDA

Key framings

## GW REPORTS AND INTERNAL DOCS

Research findings, data and stats

## GW NEWSLETTERS

Recent messaging, tone and themes

STAGE 3

## IDENTIFY THE MOST IMPOORTANT INFORMATION

what's new, what's urgent, what serves our audience and what aligns with the groundWork social media voice

STAGE 4

## FORMULATE FOR SOCIAL MEDIA

Simplify the language. Lead with the human impact.  
Use GW's voice One key message per post. Link back to source or publication

2

**Research & planning:** Gather sources and pictures, keyword research, content review, outline **Roles:** content writer, SEO specialist • **Output:** outline + sources

# Content pipeline

3

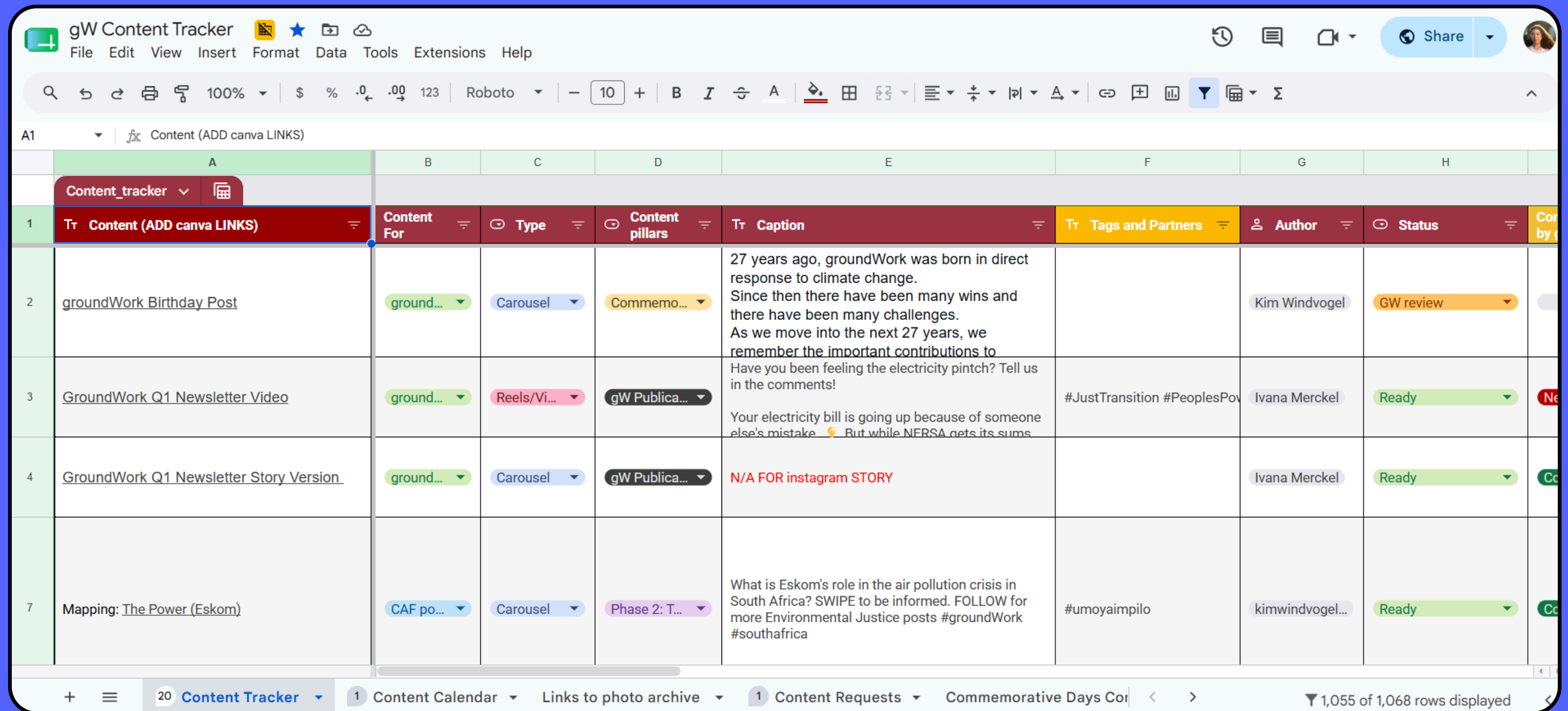
**Content creation:** Write copy, design visuals, record video, build assets  
**Roles:** writer, designer, videographer • **Output:** first draft



# Content pipeline

4

**Review & approval:** Edit for accuracy, brand voice, legal/compliance, and quality **Roles:** editor, legal, brand manager • **Output:** approved final draft



The screenshot displays the 'gW Content Tracker' spreadsheet. The interface includes a menu bar (File, Edit, View, Insert, Format, Data, Tools, Extensions, Help), a toolbar with various icons, and a search bar. The spreadsheet itself has columns for Content, Content For, Type, Content pillars, Caption, Tags and Partners, Author, Status, and a partial 'Cor by' column. The data rows represent different content items, each with a unique title, associated content, type, pillar, caption, tags, author, and status.

|   | A                                      | B           | C           | D               | E                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | F                           | G               | H         |        |
|---|----------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|-----------|--------|
|   | Content_tracker                        |             |             |                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                             |                 |           |        |
| 1 | Content (ADD canva LINKS)              | Content For | Type        | Content pillars | Caption                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Tags and Partners           | Author          | Status    | Cor by |
| 2 | groundWork Birthday Post               | ground...   | Carousel    | Commemo...      | 27 years ago, groundWork was born in direct response to climate change. Since then there have been many wins and there have been many challenges. As we move into the next 27 years, we remember the important contributions to |                             | Kim Windvogel   | GW review |        |
| 3 | GroundWork Q1 Newsletter Video         | ground...   | Reels/Vi... | gW Publica...   | Have you been feeling the electricity pinch? Tell us in the comments!<br>Your electricity bill is going up because of someone else's mistake. But while NERSA gets its sums                                                     | #JustTransition #PeoplesPow | Ivana Merckel   | Ready     | Ne     |
| 4 | GroundWork Q1 Newsletter Story Version | ground...   | Carousel    | gW Publica...   | N/A FOR instagram STORY                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                             | Ivana Merckel   | Ready     | Cc     |
| 7 | Mapping: The Power (Eskom)             | CAF po...   | Carousel    | Phase 2: T...   | What is Eskom's role in the air pollution crisis in South Africa? SWIPE to be informed. FOLLOW for more Environmental Justice posts #groundWork #southafrica                                                                    | #umoyaimpilo                | kimwindvogel... | Ready     | Cc     |

The bottom of the interface shows a tab bar with 'Content Tracker' selected, and a status bar indicating '1,055 of 1,068 rows displayed'.

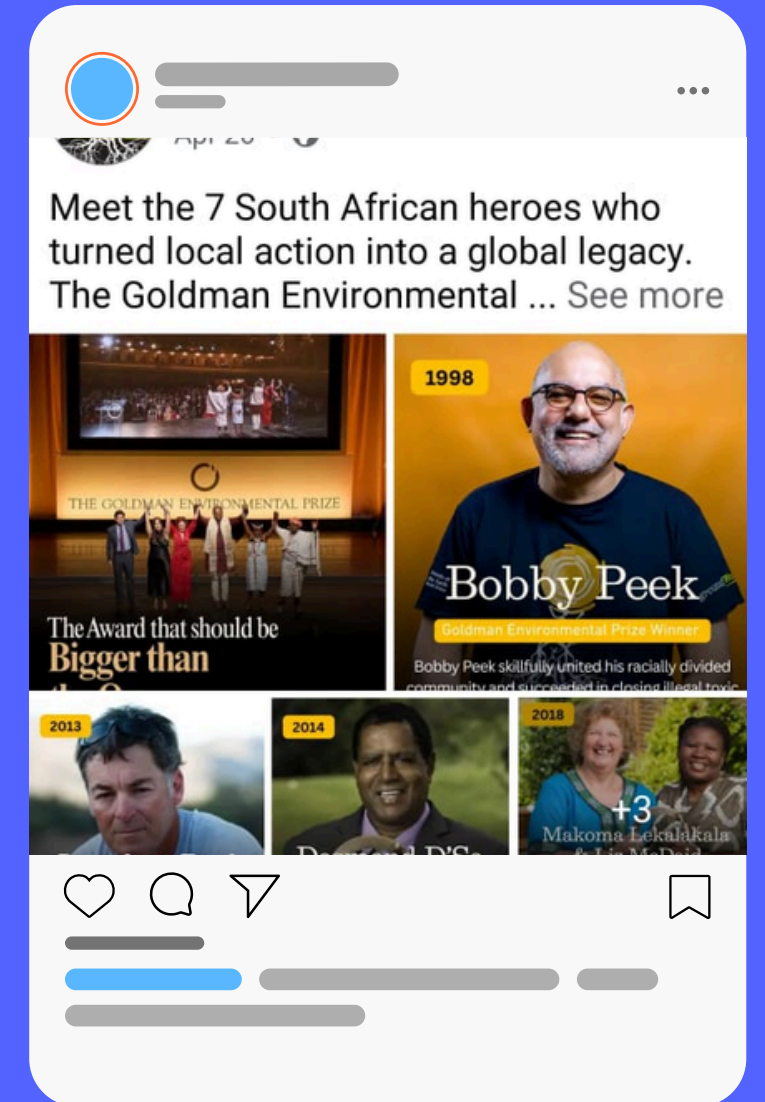
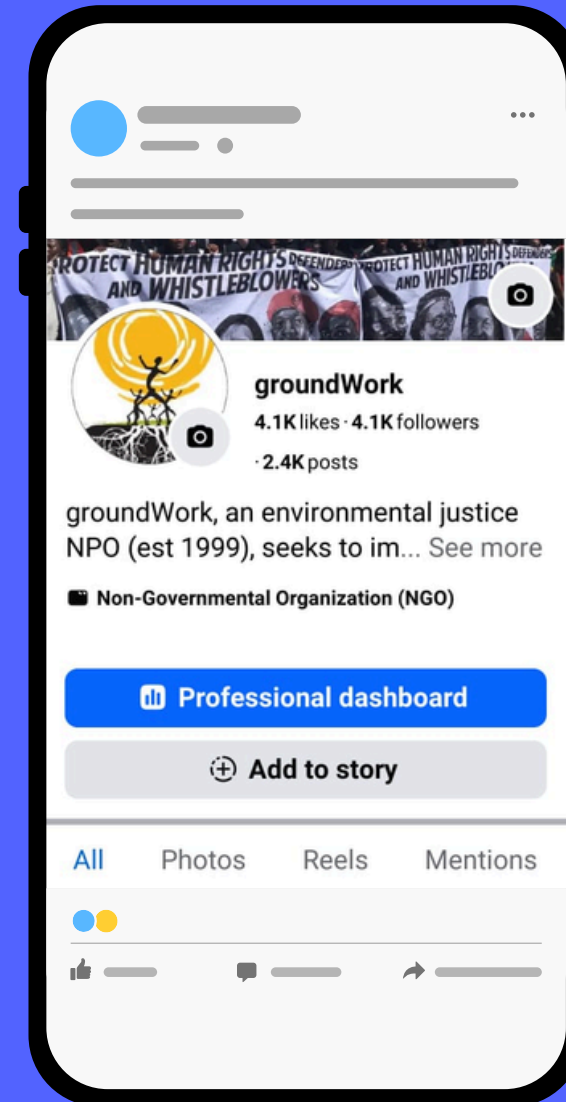
# Content pipeline

5

**Publishing & distribution** Format for channel, schedule, publish, and promote  
**Roles:** social media manager, web team • **Output:** live content

The screenshot shows a Google Sheets spreadsheet titled "gW Content Tracker". The spreadsheet is used for social media planning and contains a calendar view with columns for dates, occasions/topics, content types, driving campaigns, number of posts, and comments.

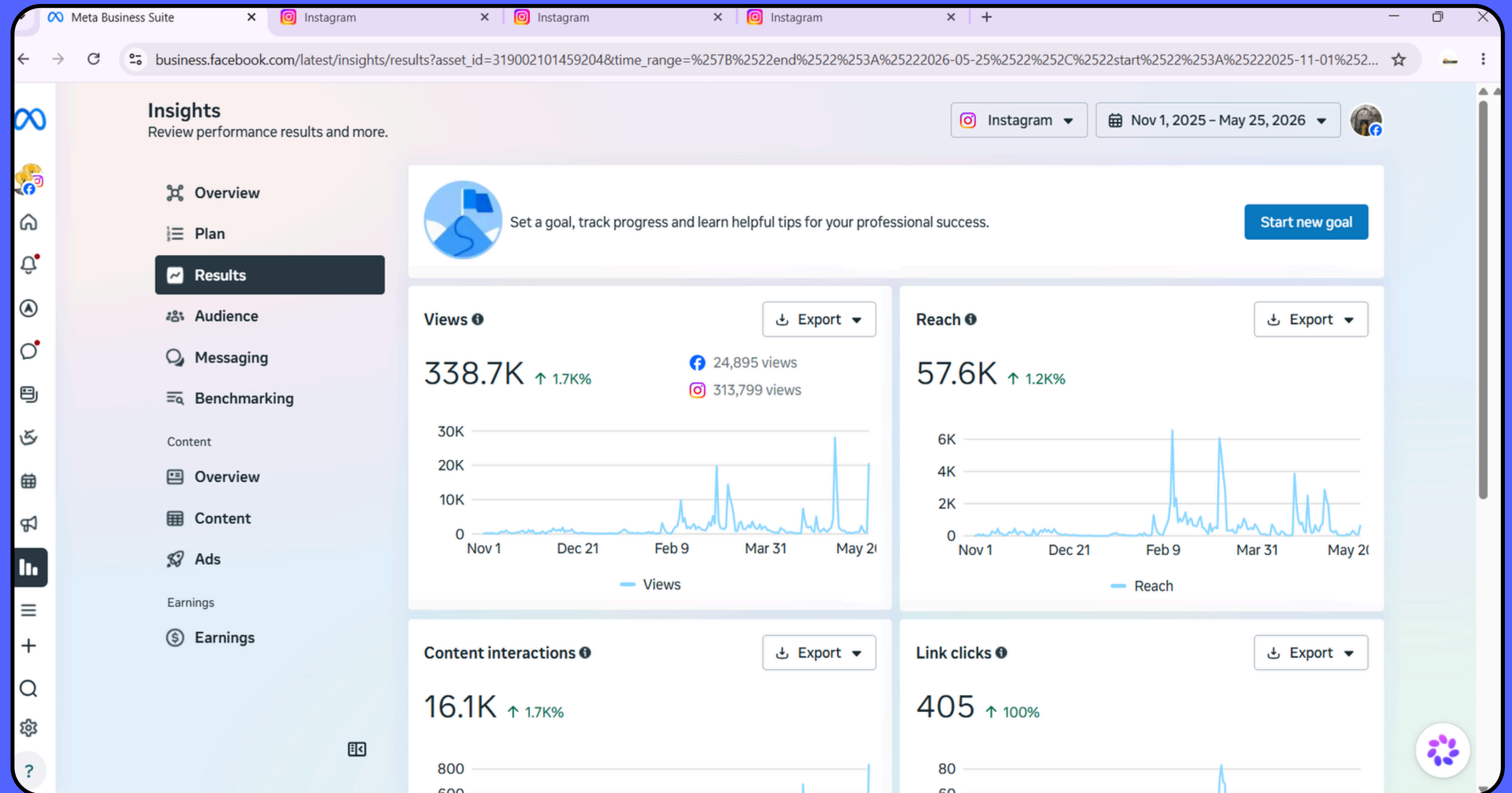
| Month/Date  | Occasion/Topic                                    | Content Type        | Driving Campaign    | Number of posts | Comments                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| April-22    | 22, 23, 24th Lephalale—showcase learning exchange | Mix Collab with EdF |                     | 4               |                                                                                                                                                              |
| April-22    | Earth Day                                         | Post and Reel       |                     | 4               | Bobby wants highlight 25 years of fighting for environmental justice                                                                                         |
| April-27    | Freedom Day                                       | Post                |                     | 4               |                                                                                                                                                              |
| May-1       | Workers Day                                       | Post                |                     | 1               | Why a Just transition is important for Worker's. Trade unions NUMSA and COSATU Naledi just transition future planning. Future of jobs in the just transition |
| May-5       | World Asthma Day                                  | Post and Reel       | GAF AQ              |                 | -GAF AQ                                                                                                                                                      |
| May 11 - 22 | AJTN EJS                                          |                     |                     |                 | Content ahead of the date 3 per week for CAF. The workshop will be covered by gW team 2 reel by gw Comms,                                                    |
| May 25      | Africa Day                                        | Post and Reels      | EJS / AJTN          |                 | Aquatrip, general gW, get vox pops ( Africa, peace, unity, RE JT )                                                                                           |
| May 28      | Menstrual Hygiene Day                             |                     | EHC/Gender warriors |                 | Plastics, landfills, health impacts of products                                                                                                              |
| June 1      | groundWork Birthday                               |                     |                     |                 |                                                                                                                                                              |
| June 5      | World Environment Day                             |                     |                     |                 |                                                                                                                                                              |
| June 7      | World Food Safety Day                             |                     |                     |                 | Monsanto, food wastage, food sovereignty                                                                                                                     |
| June 16     | Youth Day                                         |                     |                     | 1               | Youth activists: highlight their work                                                                                                                        |



# Content pipeline

6

**Measurement & learning:** Track reach, engagement, leads, and ROI against original goal. **Roles:** analyst, content lead • **Output:** performance report



# SWOT

# ANALYSIS

## STRENGTHS WHAT WE DO WELL

- Structured pipeline reduces guesswork and rework
- Clear brief aligns all stakeholders upfront
- Defined roles mean accountability at every stage
- Consistency

## WEAKNESSES WHERE WE FALL SHORT

- Review bottlenecks slow down time-to-publish
- Social media access issues
- Distribution effort often smaller than the creation effort
- Capacity to respond to comments is limited

## OPPORTUNITIES WHERE WE CAN GROW

- Investing in a social media manager
- Repurposing one piece across channels multiplies reach
- Staff education on comms reduces revision rounds
- Content audit can surface high-performers to update purpose
- Person focused video reels can improve reach

## THREATS WHAT COULD UNDERMINE US

- Ad-hoc requests bypass the pipeline and erode quality
- Platform algorithm changes reduce organic reach
- Unclear ownership causes content to stall mid-pipeline
- Resource cuts hit content first, breaking team capacity

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